

Ἀμφικράτης Ἀθηναῖος

On Illustrious Men by Amphicrates Atheniensis

eul_aid: ejw

Period: [Κλασική](#) [Classical](#)

Dialect: [Ἀττική](#) [Attic](#)

Domain: [Ῥητορική](#) [Oratory](#)

Format: [Λόγος](#) [Oration](#)

Affiliation: [Sophist](#)

Amphicrates of Athens was a Greek sophist and orator who lived during the 4th century BCE. He is recorded as having been a student of the famous Athenian rhetorician Isocrates.

His career illustrates the mobility of Greek intellectuals. He is said to have been exiled from Athens and later sought patronage at the court of the Persian king Artaxerxes. According to ancient accounts, he was initially honored there but ultimately fell from favor; his life ended with his execution by the king, though the precise circumstances are unclear.

His known work is a single, lost speech of praise titled Encomium on Philip, which was likely dedicated to Philip II of Macedon. This suggests Amphicrates was engaged with the major political powers of his era. No fragments of this or any other writings survive today.

Amphicrates is a minor but illustrative figure in the history of Greek rhetoric. His life demonstrates how skilled orators could find employment across the Greek and Persian worlds, while also highlighting the risks of depending on the favor of autocratic rulers. His connection to Isocrates places him within a significant Athenian intellectual tradition, and his attested work links him to the contemporary rise of Macedonian power.

Works (1)

- [Ἀποσπάσματα](#) · [On Illustrious Men](#) · 3 passages

Other Sophist Authors

- [Ἀχιλλεύς ὁ Τατίος ὁ Ἀλεξανδρεὺς](#) · [Achilles Tattius of Alexandria](#) · 1 work
- [Κλαύδιος Αἰλιανός](#) · [Aelian of Praeneste](#) · 4 works
- [Πόπλιος Αἴλιος Ἀριστείδης Θεόδωρος](#) · [Aelius Aristides of Smyrna](#) · 3 works
- [Αἴλιος Διονύσιος ὁ Ἀλικαρνασσεύς](#) · [Aelius Dionysius of Halicarnassus](#) · 1 work
- [Αἴλιος Θεών ὁ σοφιστής](#) · [Aelius Theon the Sophist](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀλκιδάμας ὁ Ἐλαεύς](#) · [Alcidamas of Elaea](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀλκίφρων ὁ Σοφιστής](#) · [Alciphron the Sophist](#) · 1 work
- [Ἀλέξανδρος ὁ τοῦ Νουμήνιου](#) · [Alexander Son of Numenius](#) · 2 works
- [Ἀλέξανδρος ὁ Ἐφέσιος](#) · [Alexander the Ephesian Poet](#) · 1 work

- Ἀνώνυμος ὑπόμνημα εἰς Ἀφθόνιον · Anonymous Commentary on Aphthonius · 2 works
- Ἀντιφῶν ὁ Ἀθηναῖος · Antiphon of Athens · 9 works
- Ἀντιφῶν ὁ Ῥαμνούσιος · Antiphon of Rhamnus · 1 work